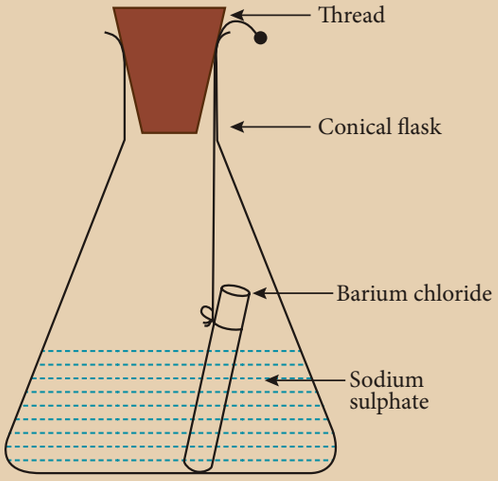
Activity 6

Prepare 5% of barium chloride (5g of $BaCl_2$ in 100 ml of water) and sodium sulphate solutions separately. Take some solution of sodium sulphate in a conical flask and some solution of barium chloride in a test tube. Hang the test tube in the conical flask. Weigh the flask with its contents. Now mix the two solutions by tilting and swirling the flask. Weigh the flask after the chemical reaction is occurred. Record your observation. It can be seen that the weight of the flask and the contents remains the same before and after the chemical change. Hence, it is proved that during a chemical change, the total mass of matter remains the same.



Consider the formation of ammonia (Haber's process) from the reaction between nitrogen and hydrogen

$$N_2 + 3H_2 \rightarrow 2NH_3$$
$$28g \quad 6g \quad 34g$$

During Haber's process the total mass of the reactant and the product are exactly same throughout the reaction.

Now, it is clear that mass is neither created nor destroyed during physical or chemical change. Thus, law of conservation of mass is proved.

12.9.2 Law of constant proportions

Law of constant proportions was proposed by the scientist **Joseph Proust** in 1779. He states that **in a pure chemical compound the elements are always present in definite proportions by mass**. He observed all the compounds with two or more elements and noticed that each of such compounds had the same elements in same proportions, irrespective of where the compound came from or who prepared it. For example, water obtained from different sources like rain, well, sea, and river will always consist of the same two elements hydrogen and oxygen, in the ratio 1:8 by mass. Similarly, the mode of preparation of compounds may be different but their composition will never change. It will be in a fixed ratio. Hence, this law is also known as 'Law of definite proportions'.

Points to Remember

- An atom consists of elementary particles like proton, electron and neutron.
- The discharge tube used in the experiment is now referred as Crookes tube or Cathode Ray Tube **(CRT)**. It is a long glass tube filled with gas and sealed at both the ends.
- Different atoms have different combining capacities. The combining capacity of an atom is known as its **valency**.
- Chemical formula is the short hand notation of a molecule of a substance (compound). It shows the actual number of atoms of each element in a molecule of a substance.
- In naming a compound containing a metal and a non-metal, the name of the metal is written first and the name of the non-metal is obtained by adding the suffix-ide to its name.
- Balancing chemical equation is necessary, so that law of conservation of mass may be obeyed.
- The law of conservation of mass states that during any chemical change, the total mass of the products is equal to the total mass of the reactants.

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